

Lab 07 - Gradients, Patterns and Symbols

Course: Creating Professional Graphics with Adobe Illustrator (TGS-2021003160) Version: v11 | 21 August 2026

Scenario

Create a packaging surface system with a gradient backdrop, seamless motif and reusable icons.

Objective

Build reusable colour and repetition systems, then improve one option through controlled experimentation.

Supplied Illustrator/vector files

- gradients.ai
- pattern.ai
- symbols.ai
- symbolsSets.ai

Detailed procedure

1. Open gradients.ai and save Lab07-Reusable-Systems.ai.
2. Create linear, radial and freeform gradient variants while holding the base shape constant.
3. Compare the variants against a stated focal-hierarchy criterion and choose one.
4. Build a seamless pattern tile; test object-only, pattern-only and combined transforms.
5. Create a symbol from an icon and place several instances with intentional overrides where supported.
6. Apply the chosen systems to a packaging panel, export a proof and record the experiment that improved it.

Evidence to retain

Editable AI master, gradient tests, seamless pattern proof, symbol instances and final packaging panel.

Acceptance criteria

- [] The selected gradient supports the intended hierarchy.
- [] The pattern has no visible seams.
- [] Symbol instances are consistent.
- [] The improvement decision is recorded and evidenced.

Reflection prompts

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- How does the Layers or Appearance panel prove that your technique remains editable?
- What rights or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?